

SI-MI: Social Identity Matters in Mentoring

Session 1: Orientation

Guiding question: What experiences have shaped how I think about mentoring?

Overview: This opening session introduces the SI-MI course and begins building the trust needed for meaningful learning together. Participants will get to know one another, reflect on their own mentoring experiences, and establish shared expectations for dialogue. The session is designed to create a supportive learning community and to frame culturally responsive mentoring as an ongoing practice.

Objectives:

- Understand the overall purpose, structure, and expectations of the course
- Begin building community with other participants through introductions and shared reflection.
- Reflect on positive and negative mentoring experiences as a foundation for later sessions.

Before the Session: These materials will help orient you to the course and prepare you to reflect on your own mentoring experiences.

- Complete the anonymous [pre-assessment survey](#)
- Complete the [participant intake form](#)
- Read the [community guidelines](#)
- Reflect on your past mentoring experiences (both positive and negative)
- Think about strategies mentors use to support mentees
- Reflect on the impact mentors have had on you or others

What to Expect in the Live Session: The live session will include introductions, an overview of the course structure, a discussion of community guidelines, and guided conversations about mentoring experiences. Participants should expect a mix of full-group discussion and small-group breakout conversations.

Takeaways: After this week, you should be able to:

- Recognize how identity shapes mentoring relationships
- Identify ways intersectionality affects mentee experiences
- Apply an identity-aware lens when mentoring